Toy as Consolation

.soft toys
.object petit a

Esra Genç

soft toy research conclusions

-children tend to interact with a soft toy on a sentimental level

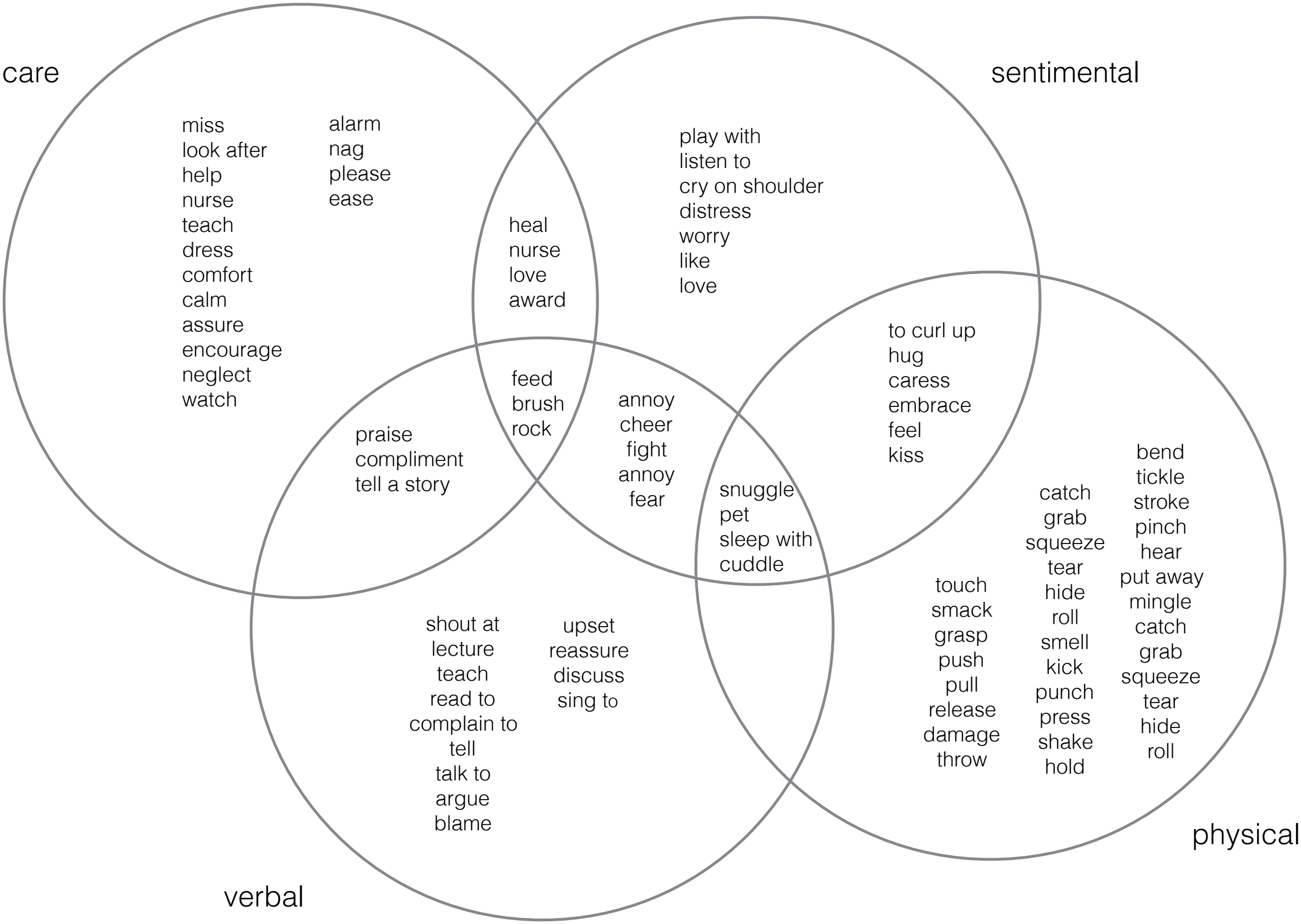
-soft toys are the companion of alienation in personal relationships

-it is common for soft toys to represent humans/animals/cartoon characters

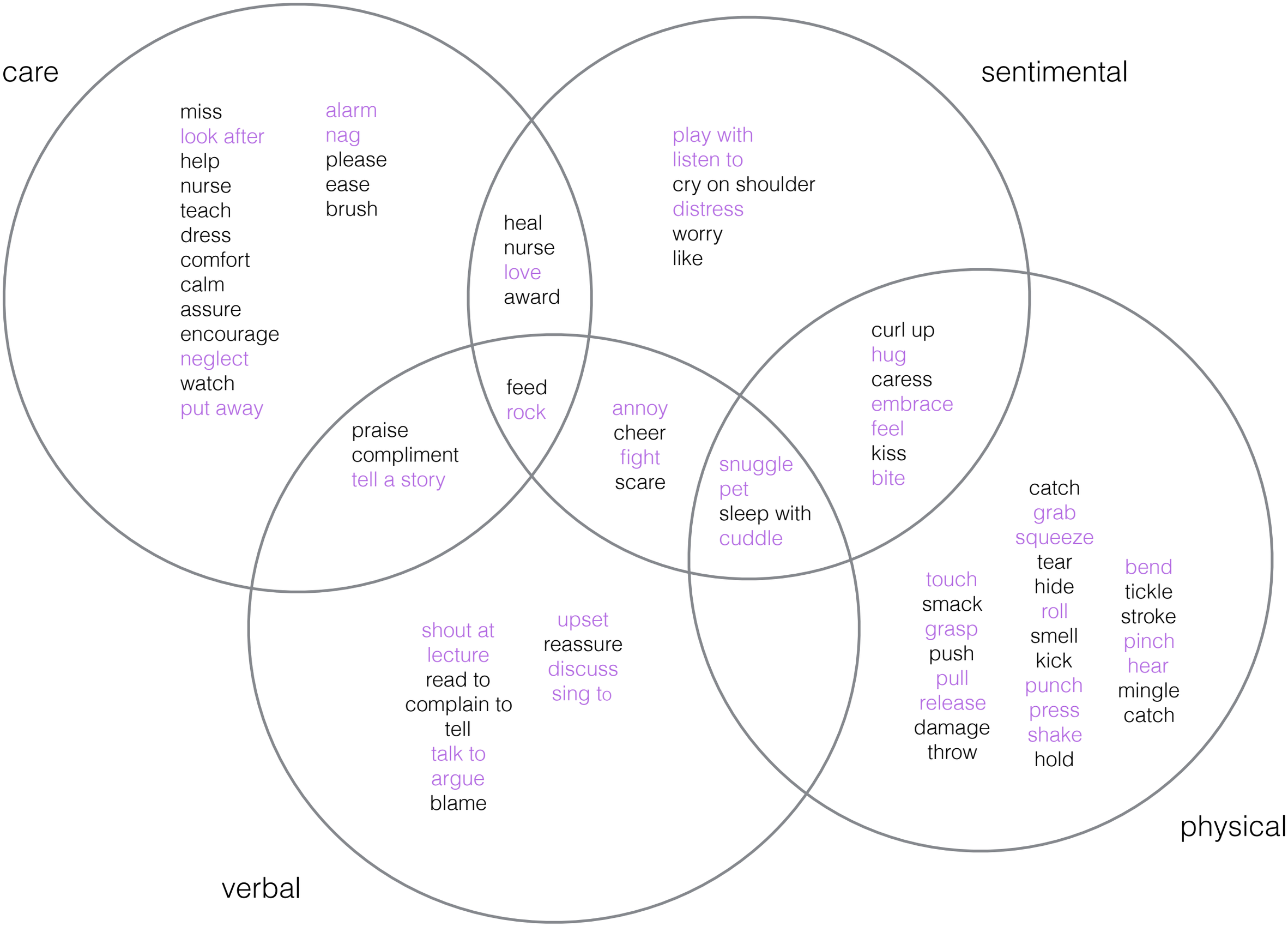
-it is possible for children to think certain inanimate toys (especially soft ones) has feelings or animate properties

-notion of jouissance can be examined through soft toys

what to do with a soft toy



what to do with a soft toy



why animate properties are assigned to inanimate soft toys?

-material (smooth, nice to touch, reminder of mother's softness and smell…)
-form (human or animal representations)
-interaction and feedback

objet petit a

(-ϕ) // petit *a*

a = autre (other)

Unattainable object of desire that we seek in the **Other**. It can take many forms, all of which are unimportant, the importance lies in what is "inside", the cause of (unconscious) desire.

Imaginary **part-object**, an element which is imagined as **separable from the rest of the body.**

The purpose of the drive is **not to reach a goal** (a final destination) but to **follow its aim** (the way itself), which is to circle round the object. **The real source of *jouissance* is the repetitive movement of this closed circuit.**

Four Concepts of Psychoanalysis

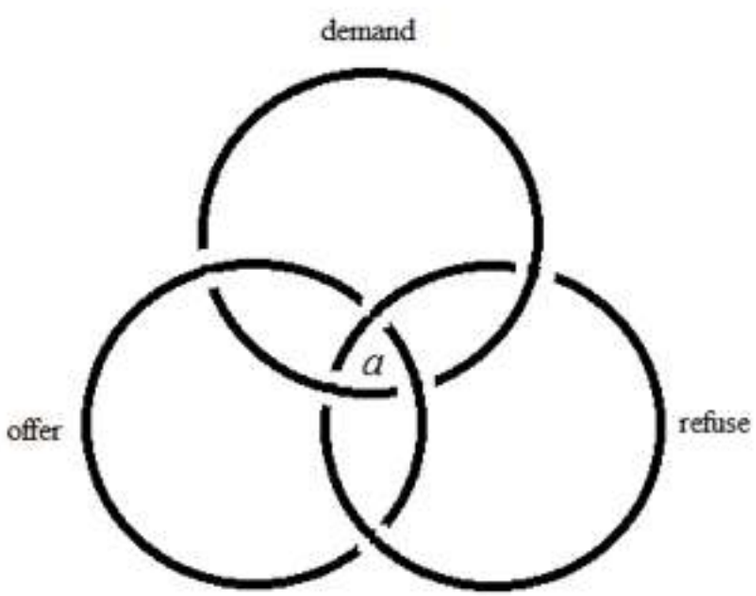
1. the active (to see)
2. the reflexive (to see oneself)
3. the passive (to make oneself be seen).
4. jouissance (to play with it)

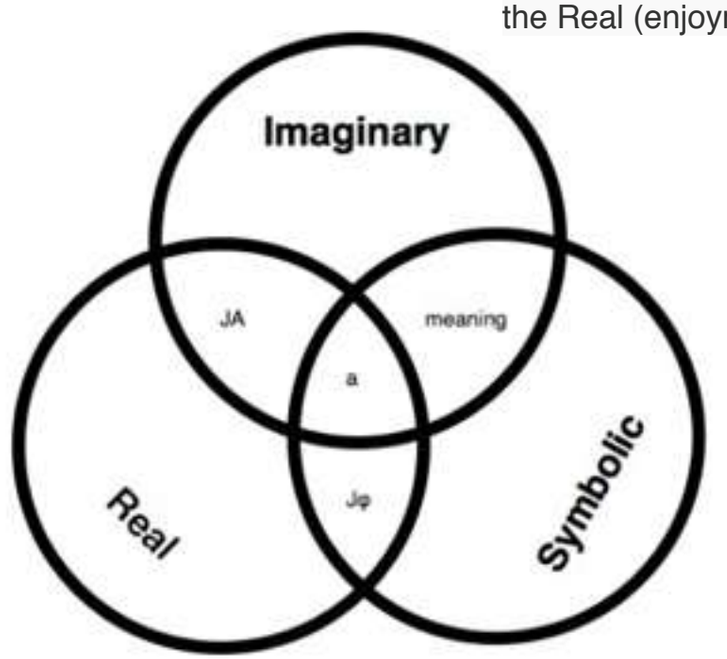
Partial Drives

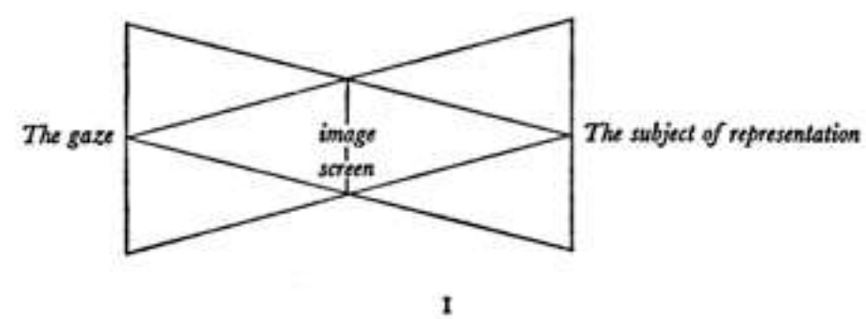
1. breast
2. feces
3. penis
4. gaze
5. voice

there is only a **certain amount of pleasure** that the subject can bear. Beyond this limit, pleasure becomes pain, and this "painful principle" is called ***jouissance***.

Imaginary (the image and its lures),
the Symbolic (the signifier and the structure of language) and
the Real (enjoyment in the body that language does not reach





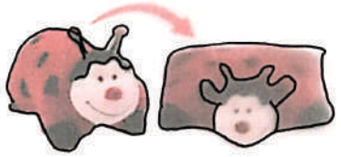


Chococat, Nakijima, 2009

The Fumbling Elephant, Nakijima

My Little Pony Soft Toy, Hasbro 2010

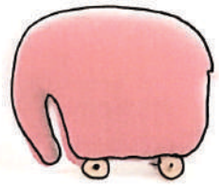
Boezels, Neo-human toys



Pillow Pets, CJ Products, 2003

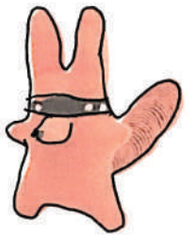
Teddy Bear, Steiff, 1880

Sock Monkey, 1932



Mohkiffantti toy, 1951

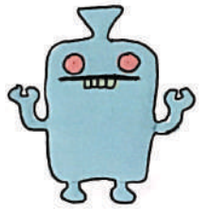
Spike Cactus, Donna Wilson



Rik, Donna Wilson

Mikey Mouse

Webkinz, Ganz, 2005



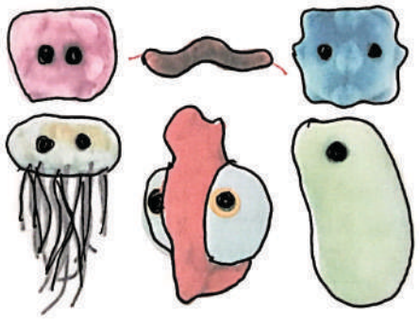
Ugly Bot, UglyDoll

Amigurumu

Monchichi, Sekiguchi Co, 1979

Hello Kitty, Sanrio, 1974

Furby, Tiger Electr 1994



Giant Microbes, Giant Microbes

Merry Mouse, Sigikid

Go Go Hamster, Zhu Zhu pets - 2008

Kramig, IKEA

Aibo Entertainment Robot, Sony

Boezels, Neo-human toys

Tamagotchi, Bandai 1996

petit a

statement

Soft toys are the loved companions which are considered to compensate the child for the absence of sibling/mother/friend and become their substitute. Most of the time, they are realistic or abstract representations of human beings(dolls)/ animals. These toys are (by owners) often considered to have living qualities.
Is it possible to create an abstract soft toy free of representation that still urges player to attach sentimental values and animate properties?

Yumuşak oyuncaklar çocukların annelerinin/kardeşlerinin/arkadaşlarının yokluğunda onların yerine geçen sevdikleri arkadaşlarıdır. Çoğunlukla hayvanların/insanların (yumuşak bebekler) gerçekçi ya da soyut temsilleridir. Bu oyuncakların sahipleri tarafından yaşamsal özellikleri olduğu düşünülür.
Gerçekçi temsilden uzak, soyut bir oyuncağa oyuncu tarafından yaşamsal özellikler atanıp onunla duygusal bağ kurması sağlanabilir mi?

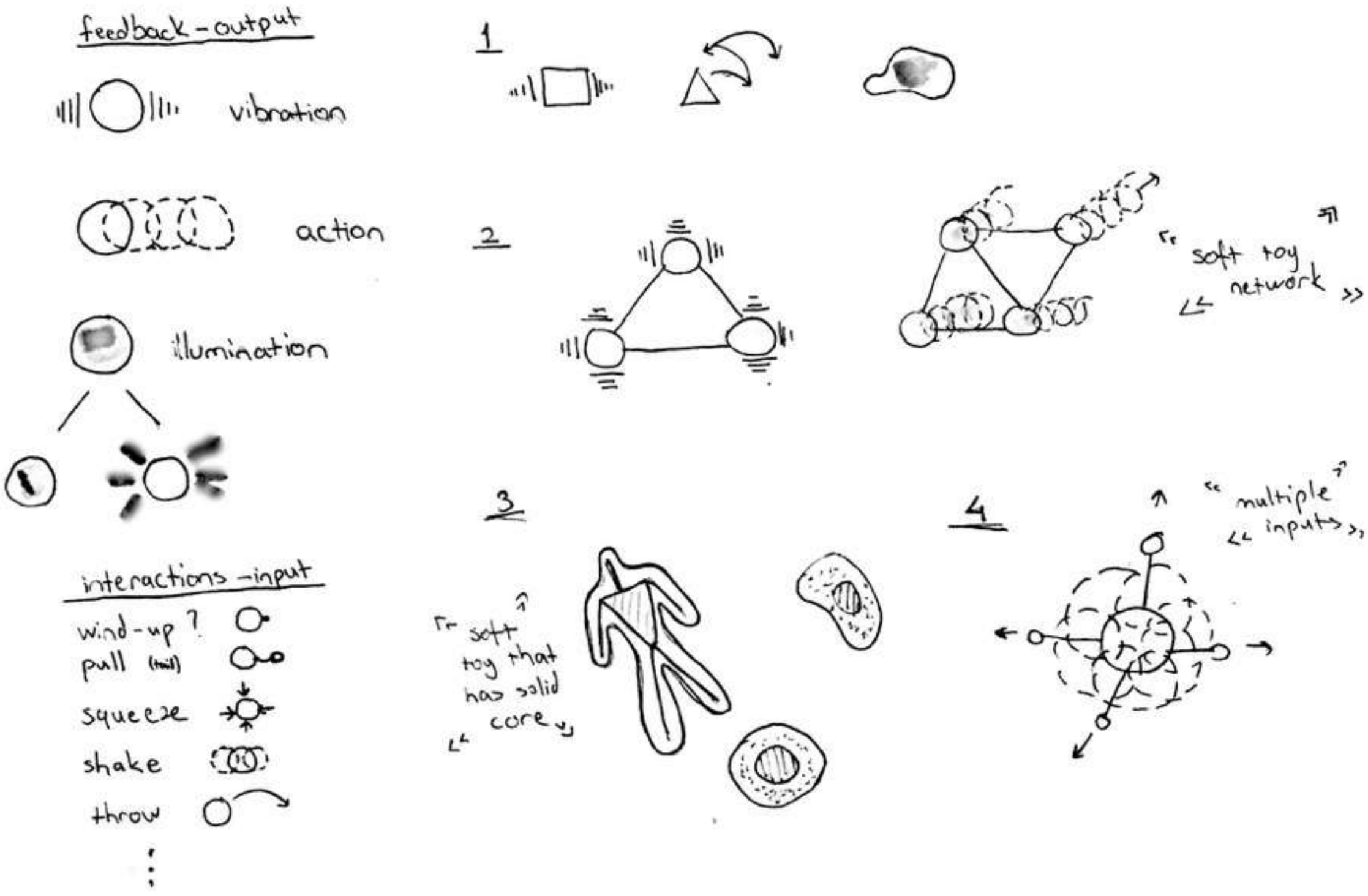
references:
Turkle, Sherry. Alone Together: Why We Expect More from Technology and Less from Each Other. New York: Basic Books, 2011

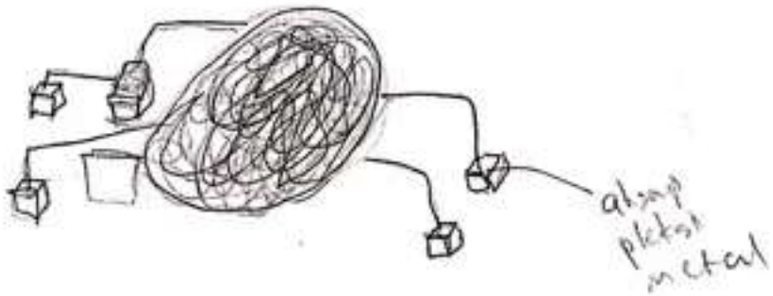
Piaget, Jean. Inhelder Bärbel. The Psychology of the Child, 1950

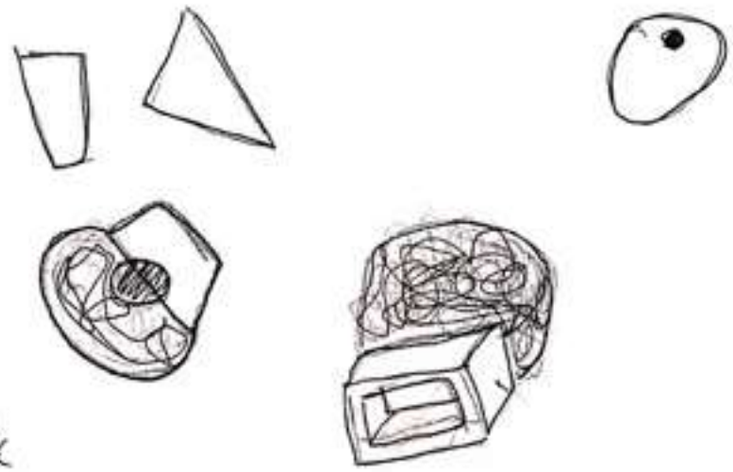
Sutton-Smith, Brian. Toys As Culture. Gardner Press, INC, 1986

Jacques Lacan, The Four Fundamental Concepts of Psycho-analysis,1994

initial sketches







- formu belirleyecek
seçi farklı
kriterlere
göre

neden
- diğe sabahlara
cevap

- boncuk silikon
emmiyeti

list of action

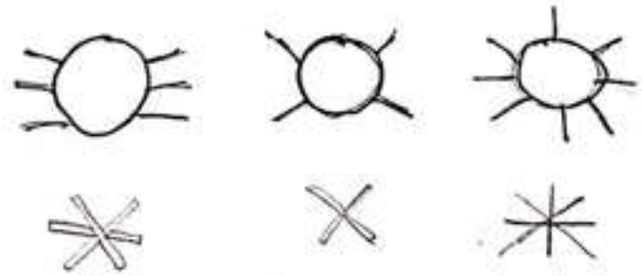
= novelty toys
elemanın super pre-defined seyler yapan
karakterlerden kaçış

knit
or
sew

stuffing
- rica
- synthetic fiber
- cotton
-

membrane
- cotton
- wool
- acrylic yarn

I

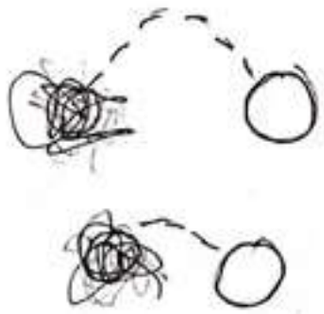


rechargeable

II

quiet

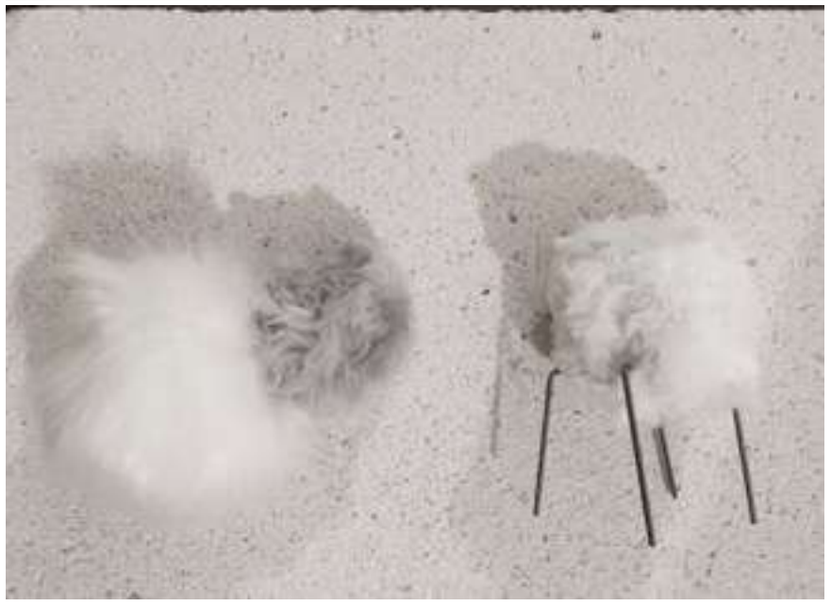
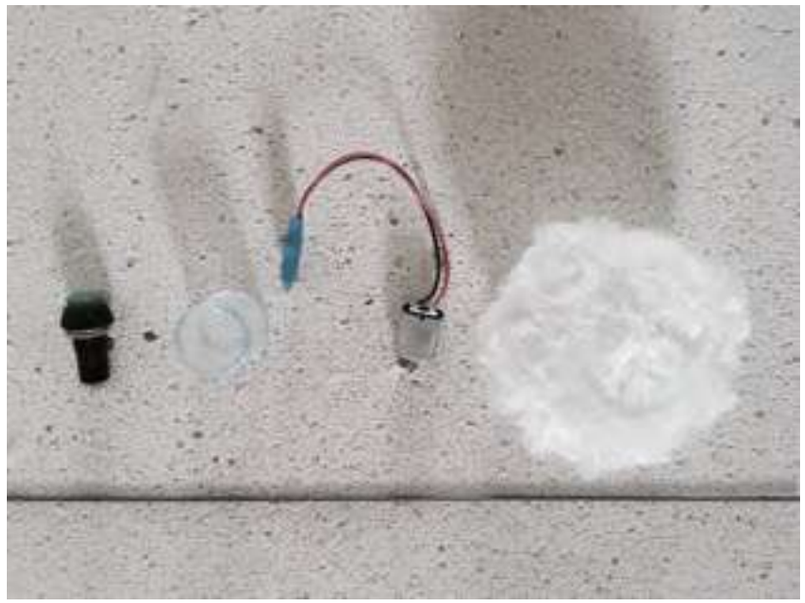
III

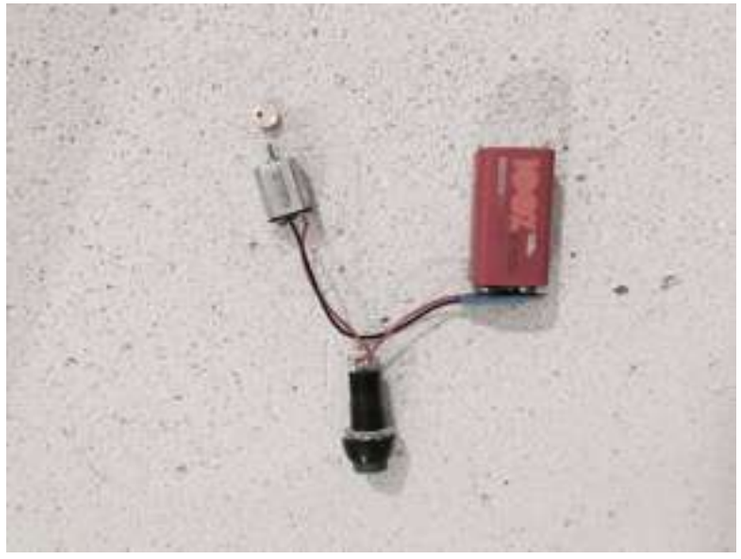
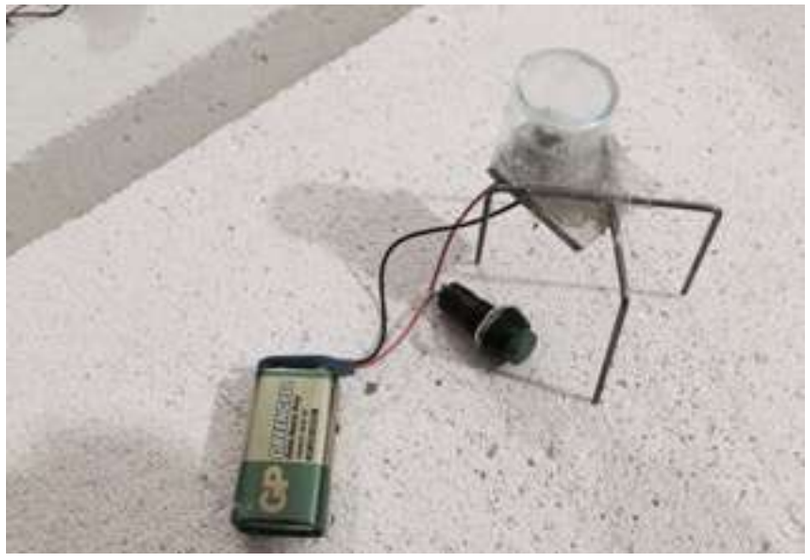


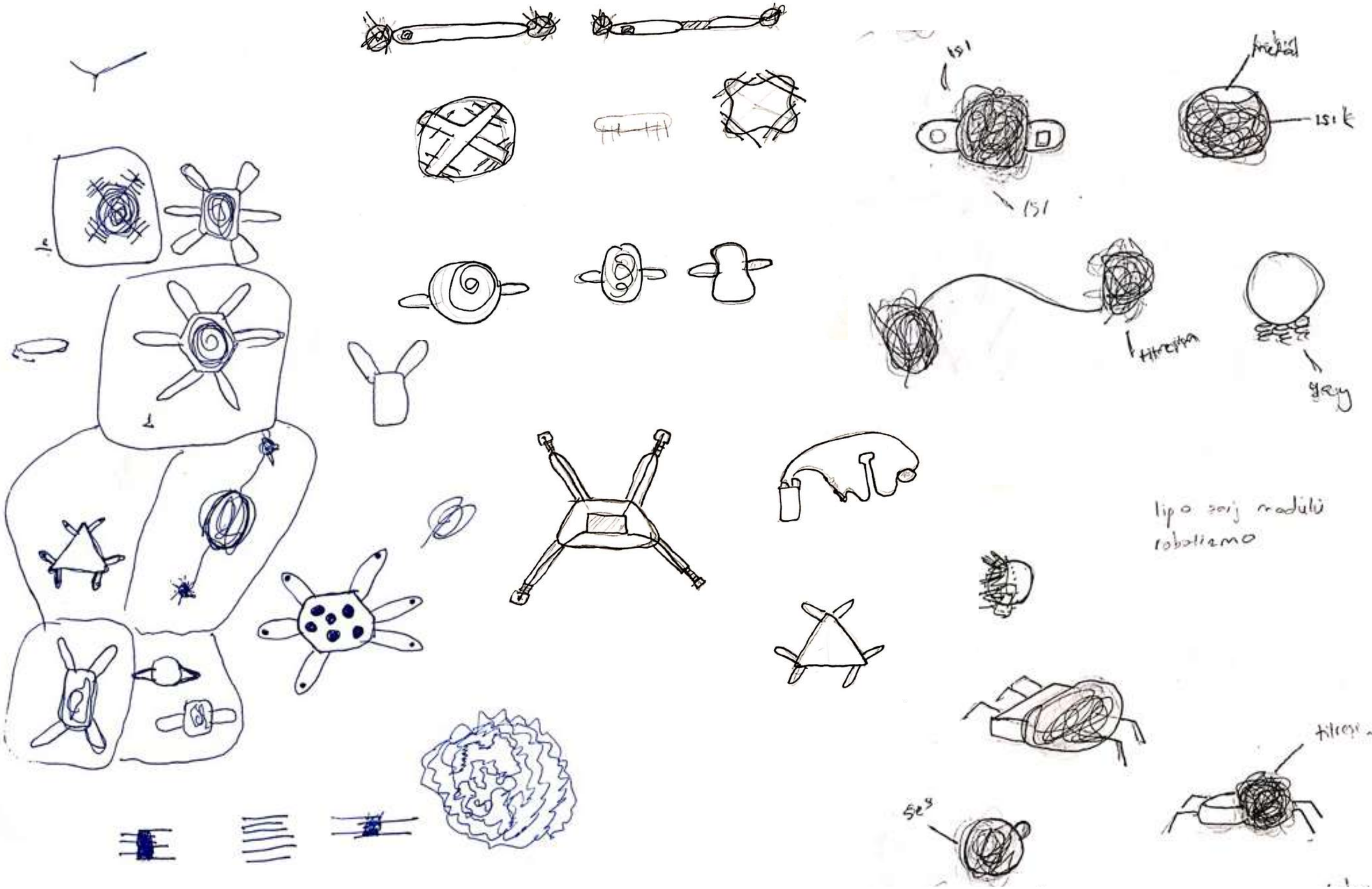
elle kontrol

IV

mock-ups


lipo zaij modulü
robotizmo

plasticity

plaˈstɪsɪti/

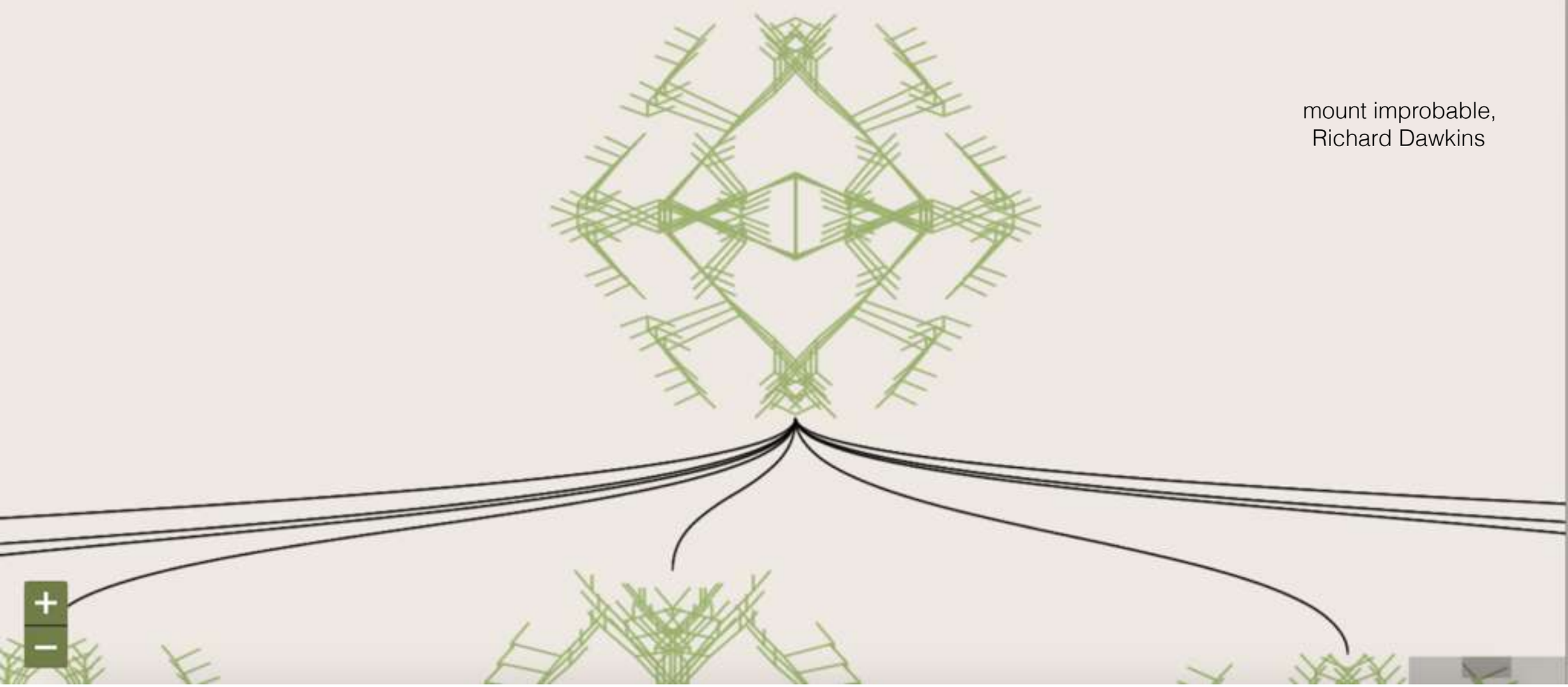
noun

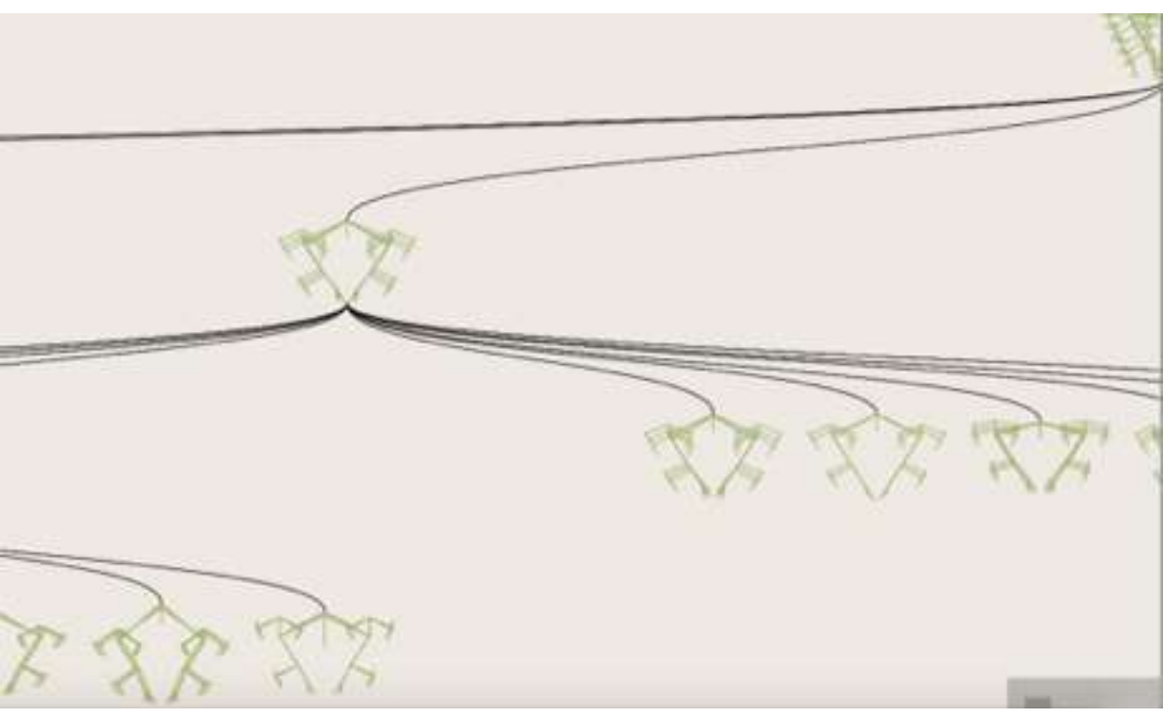
noun: **plasticity**

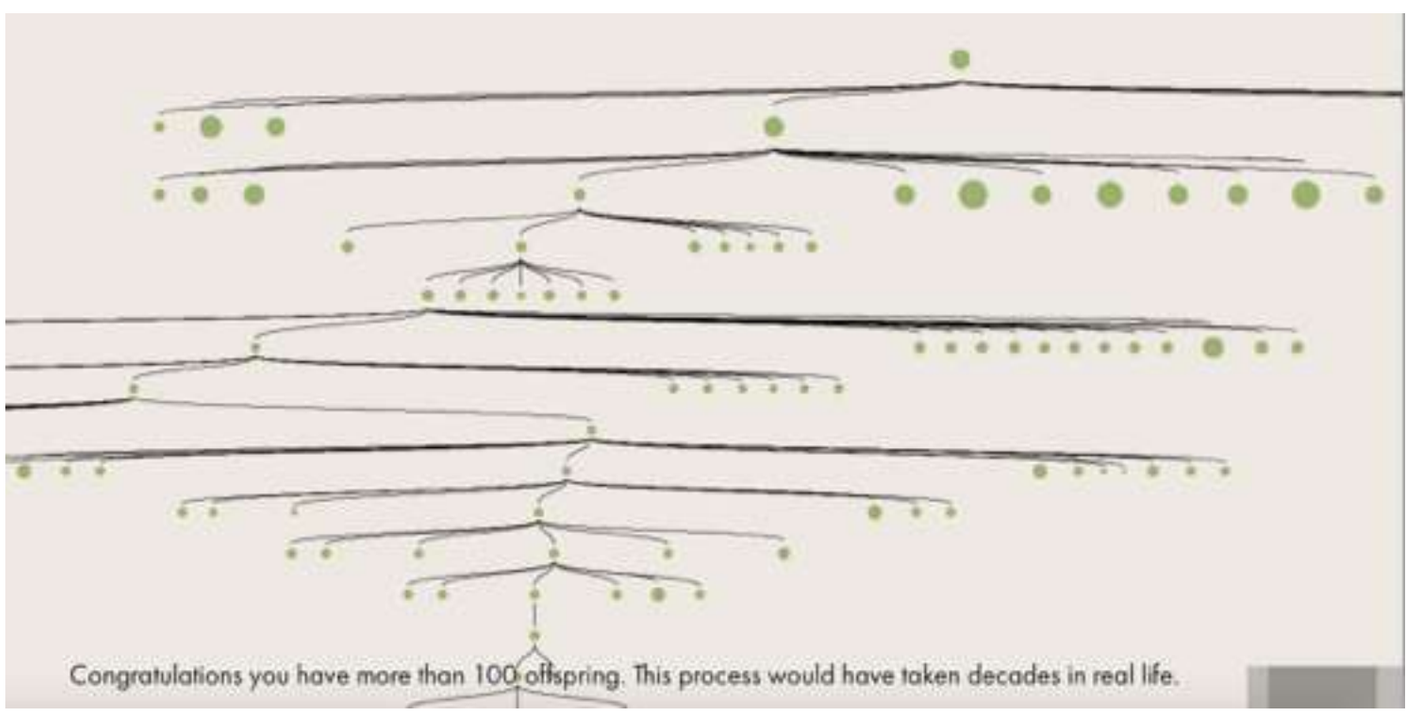
1.
the quality of being easily shaped or moulded."fine clay, at the right degree of plasticity, is more useful"

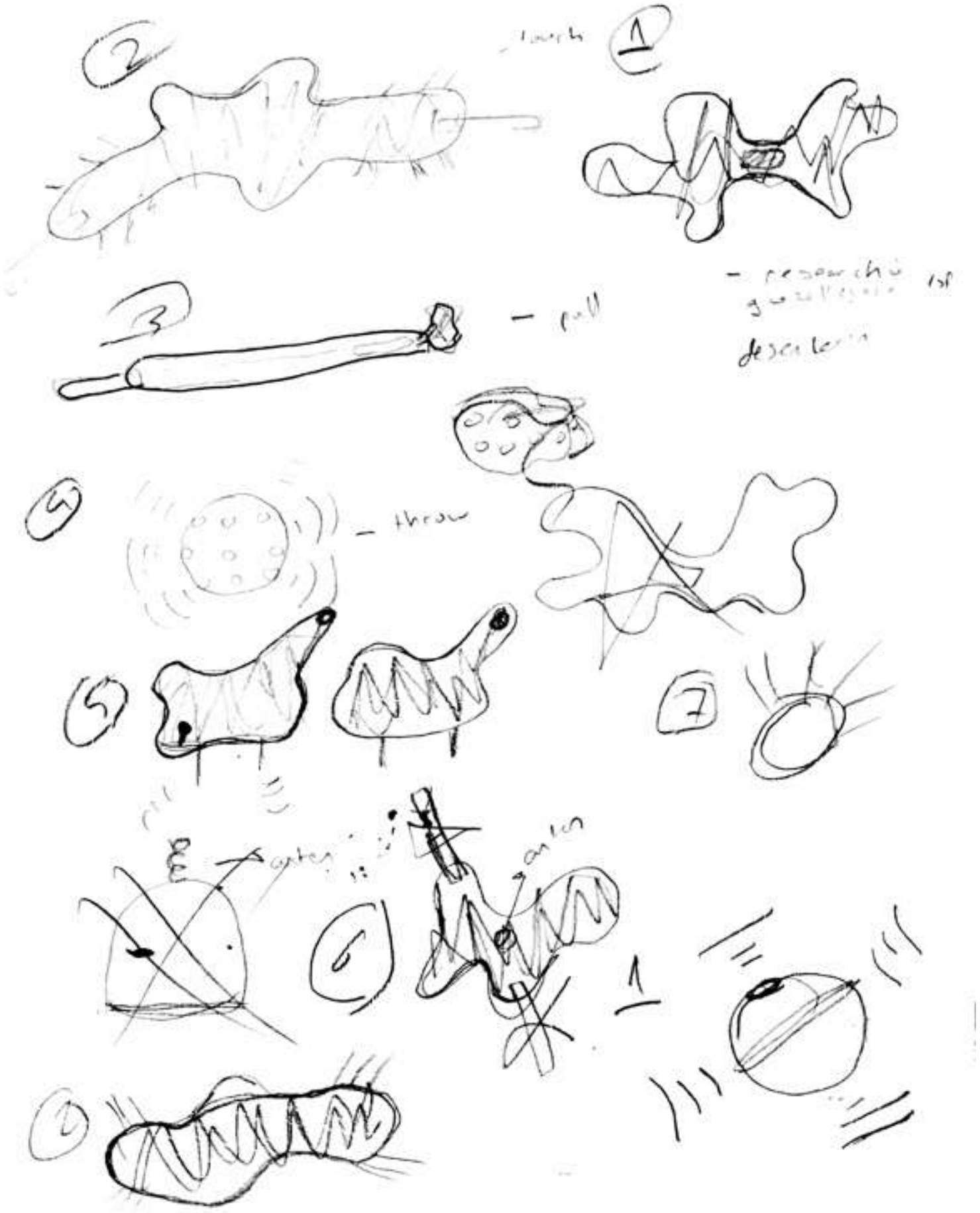
2.
BIOLOGY
the adaptability of an organism to changes in its environment or differences between its various habitats.

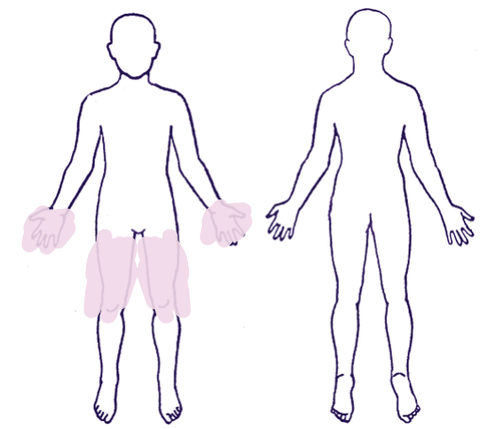
mount improbable,
Richard Dawkins

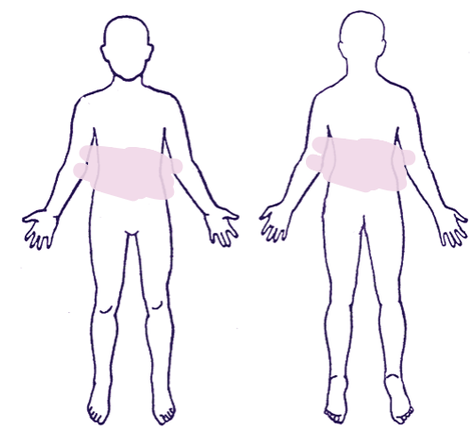












Clap

- BC547 (x2) —
- 0.1 uF (x5) —
- 100 uF (x5) —
- 1K Resistor — (100nF / ~~10uF~~ / 10uF)
- 4.7 K " —
- 330 ohms resistor —
- 555 —
- Electret condenser mic —
- 47 KΩ / 470 ohms —

Phone Detector

- CA3130 —
- BC548 transistor —
- 2.2 MΩ resistor —
- 100 KΩ resistor ✓
- 1 KΩ resistor ✓
- 100 uF capacitor ✓
- 0.22 µf capacitor ✓
- 47 pF capacitor ✓
- 9V battery clip

wifi

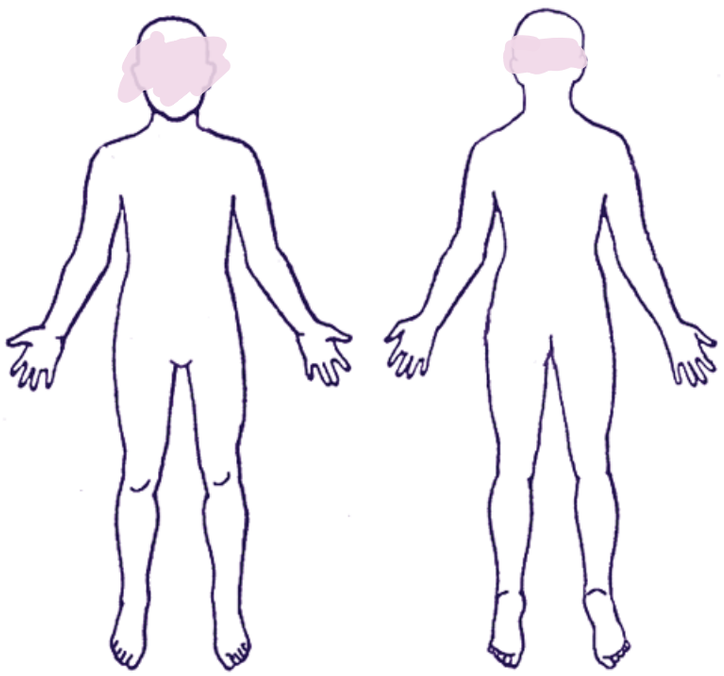
dark detector stuff

- 330 R —
- 100 K ↑
- led x10 —
- BC547 —
- 1dP x10 —

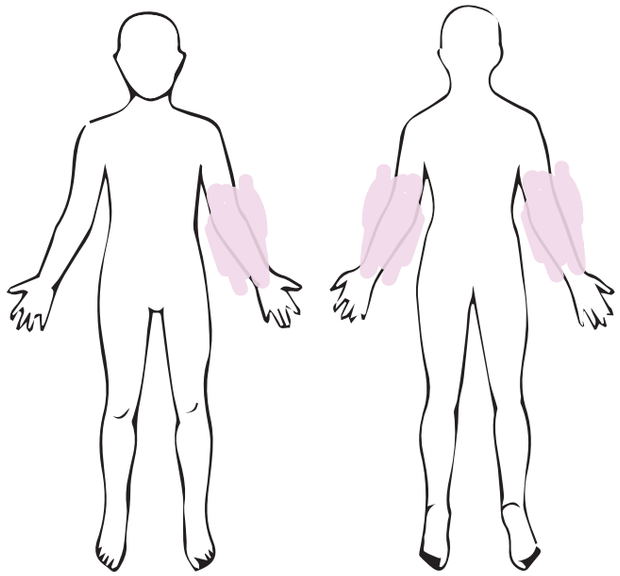
x10 — 555 —

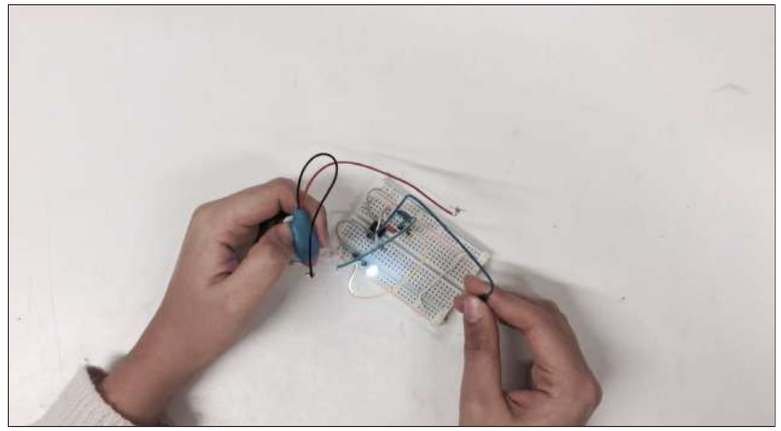
Detector

- LM 358 (x2) —
- 100 nf — 0.1 ✓
- 0.1 uf x3
- 6.8 M ohm x3 ? —
- 500k ohm x3 - pot — or variable resist
- buzzer —
- antenna



input: voice
-**blow,shout**-
output:sound
can be played
alone or with a
person





input: touch
output:light